

INCIDENT REPORT

INC-2026-002

Unauthorized SSH Access & Post-Compromise Reconnaissance

STATUS: ● CLOSED

1. INCIDENT OVERVIEW

Ticket ID	INC-2026-002
Title	Unauthorized SSH Access & Post-Compromise Reconnaissance
Analyst	Jacek Kaplon
Severity	HIGH
Detection Source	Wazuh Manager — Rule 100202 (SSH Intrusion) + Rule 100203 (Critical Activity)
First Event	2026-06-16 22:06:41 UTC — SSH brute-force attempts from 177.136.32.81
Intrusion Time	2026-06-16 22:06:43 UTC — Successful SSH login (root)
Recon Time	2026-06-16 22:06:47 UTC — Command execution: uname -a
Sensor Node	rpilab (agent.id: 017) 192.168.1.11
Classification	TRUE POSITIVE — Active Intrusion with Post-Compromise Activity

2. THREAT ACTOR PROFILE

Source IP	177.136.32.81
Geolocation	Salvador, Brazil (lat: -12.866 / lon: -38.486)
Protocol	SSH
Credential Used	username: root password: nxtDFcFd
Session ID	1e1c4ba0ff64
Sensor ID	9507f202fe70
UUID	32df9ab2-2fe7-11f1-a9b7-da8176cc5bca
data.eventid	cowrie.login.success → cowrie.command.input
Cowrie log source	/home/pi/cowrie/logs/cowrie.json

3. ATTACK TIMELINE

22:06:41 UTC		Rule 100201 (sev 5)		SSH brute-force attempt FAILED — 177.136.32.81
22:06:41 UTC		Rule 100201 (sev 5)		SSH brute-force attempt FAILED — 177.136.32.81
22:06:43 UTC		Rule 100202 (sev 7)		SSH LOGIN SUCCESS (Intrusion detected!) — 177.136.32.81
		data.eventid: cowrie.login.success		
		credential: root / nxtDFcFd		
		MITRE: T1110 (Brute Force) + T1078 (Valid Accounts)		
22:06:45 UTC		Rule 100203 (sev 10)		CRITICAL: Command execution detected — 177.136.32.81
		data.input: uname -a		
		data.message: CMD: uname -a		
		data.eventid: cowrie.command.input		
		MITRE: T1059 (Command & Scripting Interpreter) + T1105 (Ingress Tool Transfer)		
		rule.groups: post_exploitation, virus_detection		

Total time from first attempt to recon command: ~6 seconds

4. INVESTIGATION & ROOT CAUSE

Attack Pattern: Automated SSH credential stuffing followed by immediate post-compromise system reconnaissance. The speed of execution (brute-force → login → command in under 6 seconds) is consistent with a fully automated botnet or attack framework.

MITRE ATT&CK Chain:

- **T1110** — Brute Force: automated credential stuffing against SSH
- **T1078** — Valid Accounts: successful authentication using root credentials
- **T1059** — Command and Scripting Interpreter: immediate shell command execution
- **T1082** — System Information Discovery: `uname -a` fingerprinting host OS/kernel
- **T1105** — Ingress Tool Transfer: rule group flags potential payload staging intent

Assessment: The `uname -a` command is a standard first-stage reconnaissance probe used to identify the target OS and kernel version — likely preceding a decision to deploy a compatible payload. The session remained active within the Cowrie emulated environment; no actual system compromise occurred.

5. CONTAINMENT & REMEDIATION

Containment	Cowrie honeypot emulation layer contained the session — no production system access
Credentials Exposed	root / nxtDFcFd captured by honeypot — not valid on production systems
Action Taken	Session logged; full event chain exported for forensic analysis
Recommended Action	Block 177.136.32.81 at edge firewall (MikroTik / iptables); submit IP to threat intel feeds; implement Wazuh Active Response for automated SSH intrusion blocking
IoC — Source IP	177.136.32.81 (Salvador, Brazil)
IoC — Session	1e1c4ba0ff64

6. ANALYST COMMENTS & LESSONS LEARNED

This incident represents a real-world intrusion attempt against the honeypot sensor, providing high-fidelity telemetry of automated attack tooling in the wild. The attacker's behaviour — rapid brute-force followed by immediate `uname -a` execution — is consistent with mass-scanning botnets profiling targets for subsequent payload delivery.

Key observations:

- Wazuh correctly escalated severity from 5 (failed attempts) → 7 (success) → 10 (critical activity) in a linear chain — demonstrating effective rule correlation
- Post-exploitation rule group (`post_exploitation`, `virus_detection`) triggered on `uname -a` — confirming Cowrie's command watchlist is active
- GeoIP enrichment (Salvador, Brazil) was automatic — no manual lookup required
- Time from first failed attempt to recon command: **~6 seconds** — fully automated tooling confirmed

Next Step: Wazuh Active Response integration to automatically null-route source IPs upon Rule 100202 (SSH Intrusion SUCCESS) firing — preventing repeat attempts from confirmed malicious actors at the network edge.

7. INDICATORS OF COMPROMISE (IoC) SUMMARY

Type	Value	Context
IP Address	177.136.32.81	SSH brute-force source — Salvador, Brazil
IP Address	87.251.64.176	Secondary SSH intrusion source (rule 100202)
Username	root	Credential used in successful login
Password	nxtDFcFd	Captured by Cowrie honeypot emulation layer
Session ID	1e1c4ba0ff64	Active session during recon phase
Command	uname -a	Post-compromise OS fingerprinting
Rule IDs	100202 / 100203	SSH intrusion + critical activity
Geo	Brazil (-12.866 / -38.486)	GeoIP auto-enriched by Wazuh

8. REFERENCES & RELATED INCIDENTS

- INC-2026-001 — Automated Malware Triage: EICAR Pipeline Validation (VirusTotal integration)
- MITRE ATT&CK: T1110 (Brute Force), T1078 (Valid Accounts), T1059 (Command Interpreter), T1082 (System Info Discovery), T1105 (Ingress Tool Transfer)
- Cowrie Honeypot documentation: cowrie.readthedocs.io
- Wazuh Rule reference: rules 100201, 100202, 100203 — custom Cowrie decoder
- Full project repository: github.com/jacekkaplon/The-Littlefish-Hunter